

r/aiwars

Genuine question about AI and water usage

Posted by u/Select_External7595 • 0 points • 70 comments

Hey, I've seen a lot of people bring up water usage as a reason to be anti-AI, and I'm genuinely curious. How is the water consumption from AI data centers any different from the data centers that power everything else we use online? Like YouTube, Netflix, gaming servers, social media, cloud storage, etc. All of those rely on data centers too, right?

If anyone knows what makes AI's water use specifically worse or unique, I'd love to understand.

Comments

u/abbe44 • 1 points • 2026-03-19 08:28 UTC

It doesn't really matter if its more or less

There are water shortages in many places and the fact we're using it at all for something so useless as generative AI is abhorrent

u/Valuable_Pay9615 • 1 points • 2026-02-22 22:46 UTC

Couldn't they make the centers smaller and just air cool them??

u/SwagMaster9000_2017 • 1 points • 2026-03-27 18:39 UTC

AI Models need to be big. Data centers need to be big

u/lactosefr33milkshake • 2 points • 2026-01-31 04:26 UTC

Finally a fucking thread that explains this cuz i was so confused